

7.8

Presenting a process/system

Worksheet

- A** The language in the table is useful for describing processes and systems.

Division into parts	X includes/involves ... X is composed of/consists of ... X can be divided into three main stages/steps/parts/types
Sequence	First, ... First of all, ... At the first stage we ... Second, ... The second step involves ... Then, ... Next, ... After that, ... Following that, ... At the next stage we ... Finally, ... The final step is to ... At the final stage we ...
Time reference	earlier: Before that, ... during the same period: Meanwhile,, while ... immediately after: When ... As soon as ... later: After (+ <i>ing</i> form of verb) Having (+ p.p. of verb)
Passive voice	The food is sorted/prepared/cooked/checked for quality/measured/put into cans/labeled/dispatched This machine is used to (+ infinitive) / is used for (+ <i>ing</i> form of verb)

The text below explains how a customer in Angola pays for some agricultural machinery from a supplier in Brazil. Underline all the examples of language from the table.

The process of paying for goods involves banks in Angola, Brazil and New York and can be divided into four or five main stages.

First, the customer in Angola contacts the local agent of an AAA-rated New York bank. The customer deposits some funds or gives a guarantee to cover payment of the goods. This allows him/her to place the order with the supplier in Brazil. When the supplier receives the order, he/she issues a 'pro-forma' invoice (an invoice sent in advance of goods) and sends it to the customer.

Next, the customer in Angola takes the pro-forma invoice to the local bank. The bank issues a letter of credit (l.c.) – this means that the order cannot be cancelled. The l.c. is sent to a Brazilian agent of the same New York bank, and as soon as it arrives the agent contacts the supplier. After that the supplier can process the order and the goods are shipped.

The next step involves the Brazilian agent checking all the documents to see if everything is correct. Having done this, the agent sends the documents to the main bank in New York. The New York bank checks everything one more time and sends the documents to the agent in Angola. When they arrive, the customer's payment is released and the money is transferred, first to New York and then to Brazil. This usually happens while the goods are still in transit.

Finally, the supplier receives the money. The whole process is used for making sure there are no problems with payment.

- B** Prepare and give a presentation on a process or system that is important in your work. You may want to draw a diagram or list the main stages on the board before you begin.

